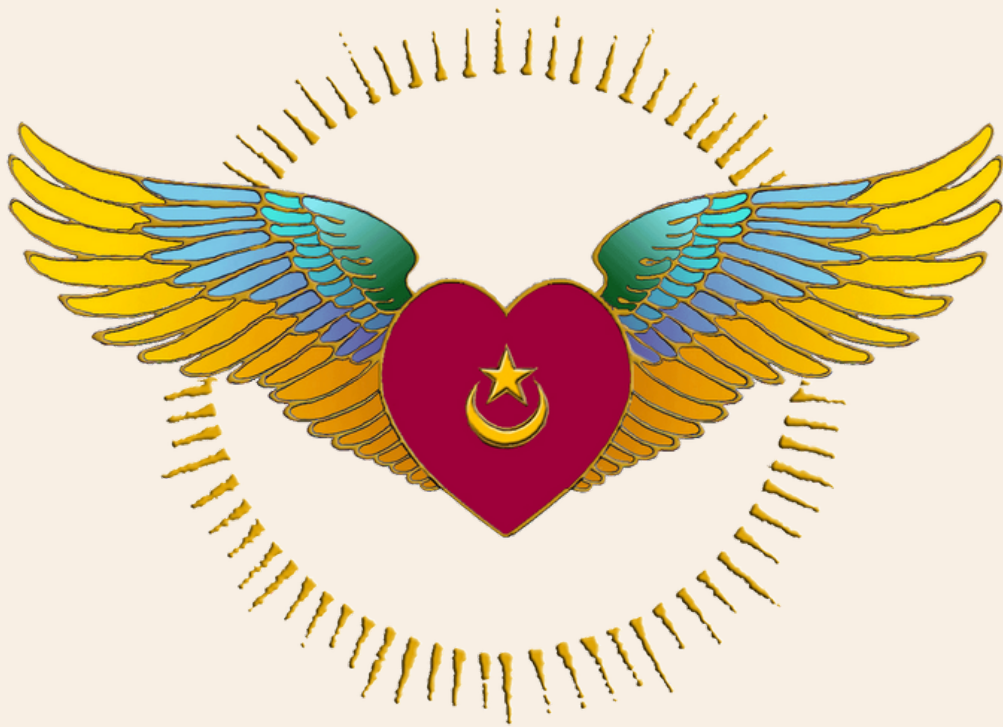


God is Breath



Lesson 2
Commentary,
Summery, &
Symbol

Toward the One, the Perfection of Love, Harmony, and Beauty,
the Only Being, United with All the Illuminated Souls
Who Form the Embodiment of the Master, the Spirit of Guidance.

GATHA WITH COMMENTARY SERIES I: NUMBER 7

Symbology of the Dot and Circle

RYAZAT: Breathe in, concentrating on inhalation until there is a clear idea of the processes of inhalation. Breathe out, concentrating on exhalation until there is a clear idea of exhalation. Breathe in and out, in and out until there is a clear understanding of Breath as it is.

RYAZAT: Gaze at a point preferably in black ink or paint at the level of the eyes. Gaze steadfastly at that point repeating, "Toward the One, etc." Here this One means the point itself. The breath should be in rhythm. One should be relaxed. The point becomes a center of concentration as in archery.

GATHA: The dot is the most important of all figures, for every figure is an extension of the dot and the dot is the source of every figure. You cannot let a pen touch paper without making a dot first of all.

GATHA: At the same time the dot means zero, meaning nothing. It is nothing and it is everything, and the dot expresses the symbol of nothing being everything and everything being nothing.

RYAZAT: Begin to concentrate on the dot dynamically. Inhale becoming the dot, and let that dot expand in and with the exhalation.

TASAWWUF: As one breathes and her breath becomes identified with the dot and as the dot activates into expanding creation, so also does one realize the principle of expanding consciousness.

GATHA: The dot develops into the circle, which shows the picture of this seemingly non-existent developing into all-existing.

GATHA: As the dot enriches the figure so God enriches the human being; as all figures come from the dot so all things and beings come from God; and as destruction must in time break all things into dots so all things must return to God.

TASAWWUF: In breathing we inhales into the Bindu or Point and exhales into the expansive sea or Sindhu. This is known as Bindhu-Sindhu in the Hindu teachings, and the Dot-Circle elsewhere. The dot thus posits the Ego, and the circle posits the assimilation of the Ego in the All. In the All, separate entities as such do not exist.

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Sangatheka Series II Z: DC

Dot and Circle

This concentration is to regulate the states of expansion and contraction of the heart, which are so apt to result from continued practice of Zikr.

By it one avoids extremes, for expansion of consciousness may come with sobriety, and contraction may occur without harmful reactions.

Nevertheless, the meaning of this practice and of Zikr is almost identical although the concentration is not so powerful as the chant.

It may be used with Fikr when Zikr is impossible, to take the place of Zikr. Or it may be used separately from Fikr at another time.

This controls strong spirited persons without humiliating them, leaving them with strength.

This one learns of harmony and unity through inner development, even more than through being taught by another.

When one cannot read, or is where there are no teachings, these practices together will give all the spiritual nourishment needed.

This concentration is also good for those who are deficient in the sense faculties, especially seeing.

This opens the eyes of the blind on all planes, to the wonders of those planes.

Through this one learns real spiritual humility without cost to honor or personality. One also learns how to regulate her affairs with others.

The purpose of life becomes more realized through this practice.

This regulates the light of Zikr and transmits it to the body and mind without affecting the emotions very much. In general it tends to sobriety rather than intoxication and is very good for the emotional, as it always helps expand the heart at the same time.

Ya Ahad, Ya Samad

From Chapter 5 Summaries in Physicians of the Heart

65. Ya Ahad (yaa A-ad)

Al-Ahad means total and absolute Oneness. It is the One of the One. It should not be confused with the conception of the totality of all things. Oneness is an essential characteristic of Allah. God is absolutely singular and unique. Al-Ahad is the One without a second. It is a unicity. You can't add the one of al-Ahad to itself, and get two. In its concreteness, only One is. It has no opposite. Nothing is like this One. From the view of al-Ahad, of unity, no distinctions are made between the different Prophets of God. Each one of them is a complete entity of the whole. Al-Ahad is the center of a circle without a circumference. See Ya Samad (66) below, with which it is often paired in recitation.

66. Ya Samad (yaa ŞA-mad)

As-Samad is the continuity of Eternity. It is the circumference of the circle that expands eternally, whose center is everywhere. It is infinite expansive space. The root form *samadan* means continuously. As-Samad is the relationship between al-Ahad, the One of the One, and al-Wahid, the One of the Many.

In as-Samad, the difference between these two kinds of Oneness cannot even be conceptualized. In recitation, you invoke Ya Ahad, the infinite dot or singularity, and pair it with Ya Samad, the infinite circle that expands eternally. Invoking them as a pair will assist in bringing you true balance in life. As-Samad is connected with the word *samada*, which means castle or citadel. It conveys the sense that the ground on which you need to stand is infinite.

In the fikr, inhale Ya Ahad and exhale Ya Samad. When inhaling come into a one-pointedness of being, remembering your real self is not separate from the all-inclusive eternal stillness of the Arsh (Heart) throne of God. When exhaling experience this essence continuously expanding in self-expression.

In the fikr-as-sirr continue this contemplation on the breath, dwelling in the essence without giving it any names.

